



WHAT THE FRANKFURT ROOM TOLD US

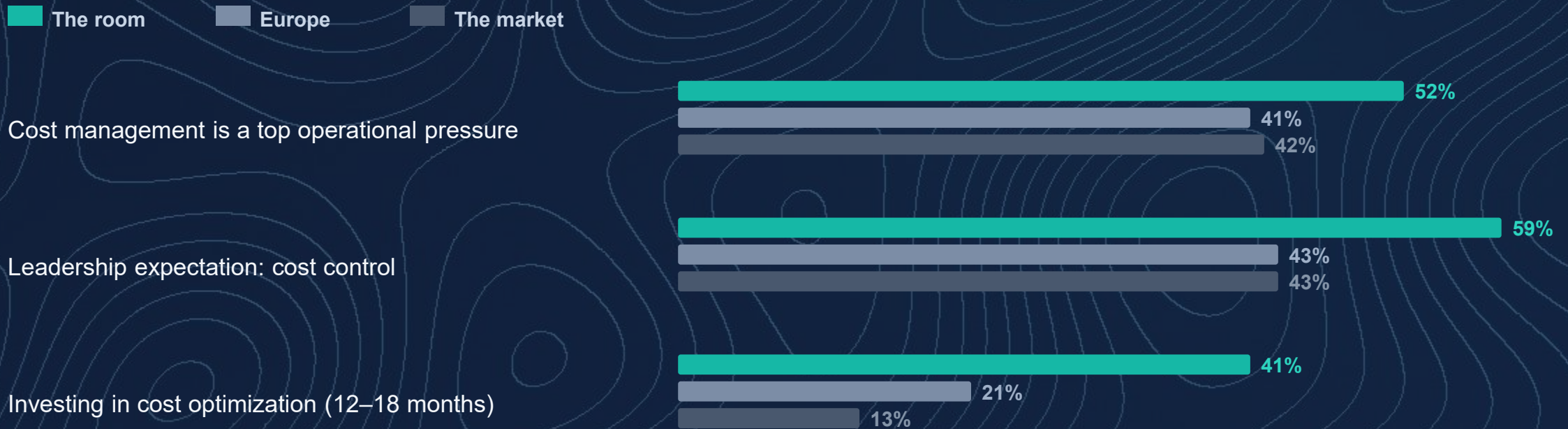
GME Leaders Exchange · Frankfurt · 2026

A CBIQ Insights briefing for delegates. 27 delegate organizations, measured against Europe and the full global market.

THE COST DOUBLE-BIND

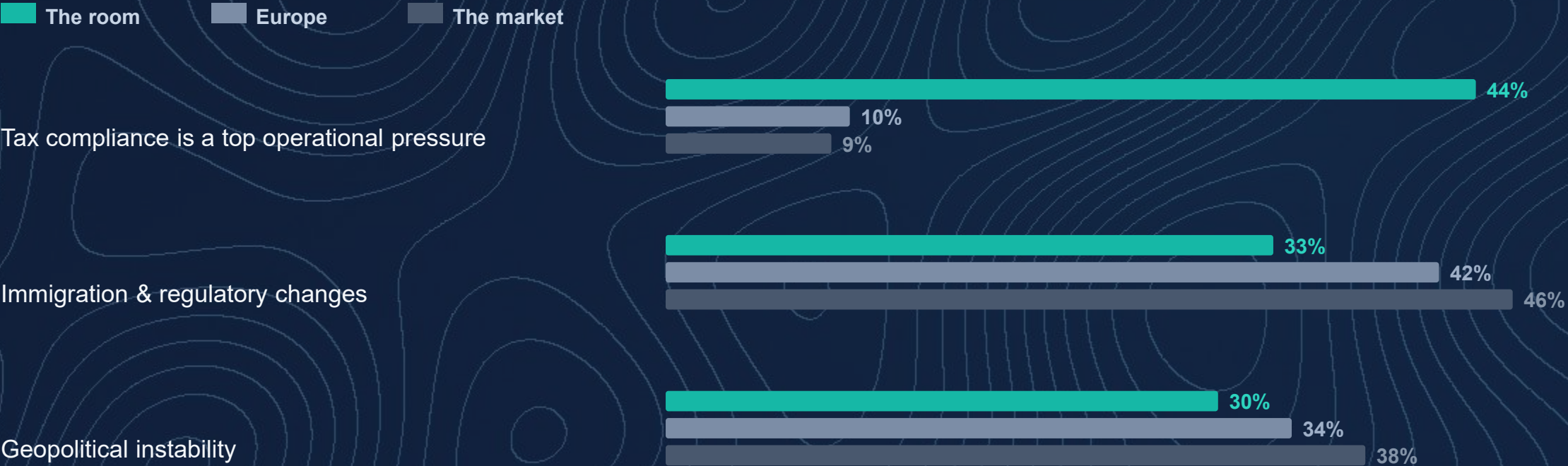
Frankfurt is acting where the market is still talking.

Cost sits at the top of this room twice: the number one operational pressure, and what leadership most expects. What sets Frankfurt apart is the response, investing in cost optimization at twice the European rate and more than three times the global.



Room base 27 · Europe 171–226 · Market 637–760. The market talks about cost; Frankfurt is resourcing the answer.

Immigration drops to third, displaced by tax.



Operational pressures (select up to 3). Room base 27 · Europe · Market. Frankfurt's compliance anxiety is fiscal, not border-shaped.

Tax compliance: more than four times the market rate. The single most distinctive figure in this room.

THE ROOM

44%

name tax compliance a top operational pressure

For context

Europe

10%

The market

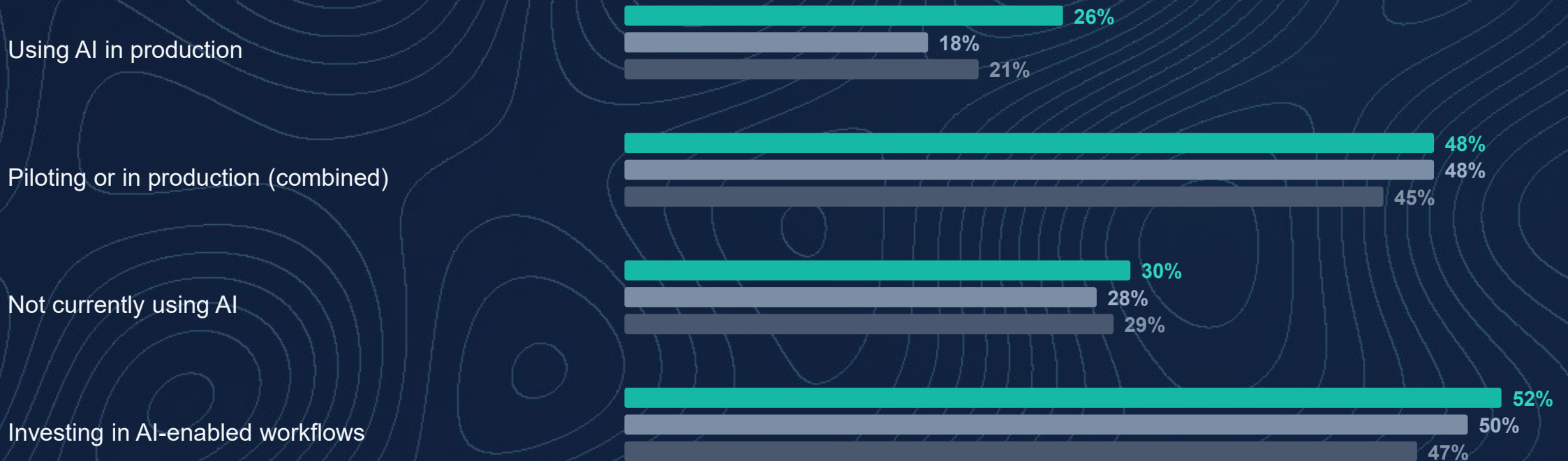
9%

The German operating reality of shadow payroll, cross-border commuters, and an enforcement environment that has sharpened faster than program processes have.

Operational pressures (select up to 3). Room base 27 · Europe · Market.

Ahead on production. Number one on ambition, exactly like everywhere else.

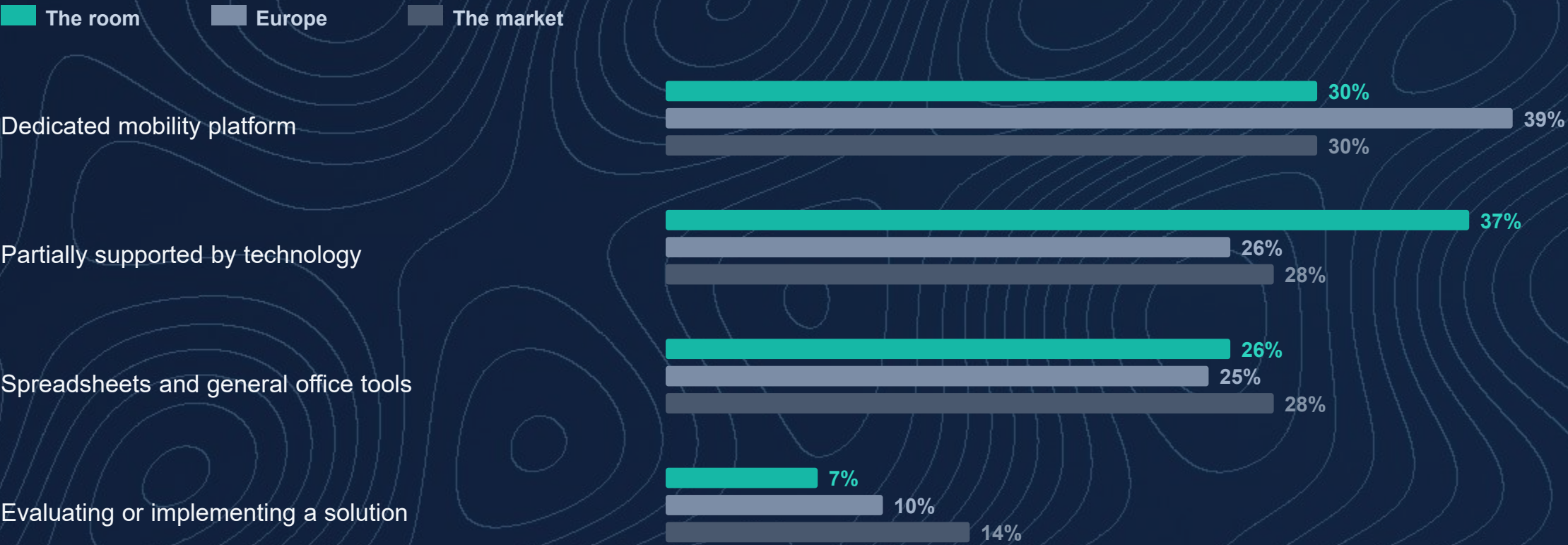
■ The room ■ Europe ■ The market



AI adoption and investment. Room-base 27 · Europe · Market. A confident front third, a waiting third, almost nobody claiming AI is off the agenda.

THE PLATFORM GAP · A ROOM ON PARTIAL FOUNDATIONS

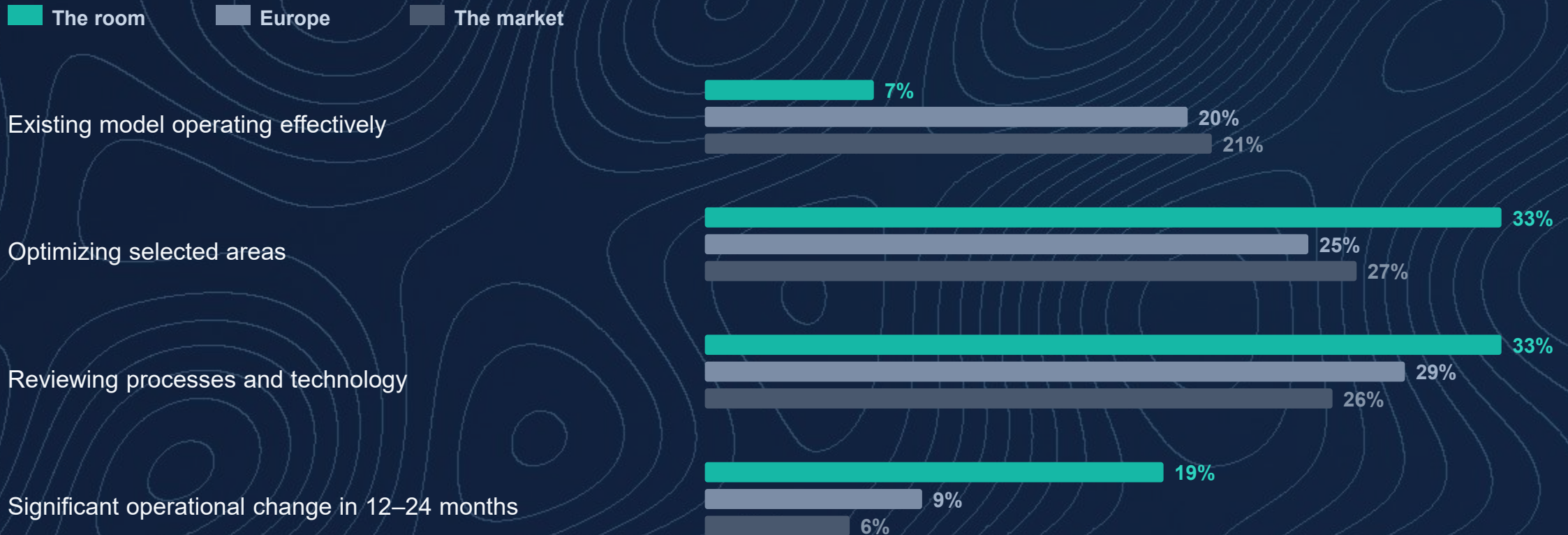
For all its cost discipline and AI production, Frankfurt trails Europe on the basics.



Technology maturity. Room base 27 · Europe · Market. A room of half-built stacks, which is where the cost and automation investment is headed.

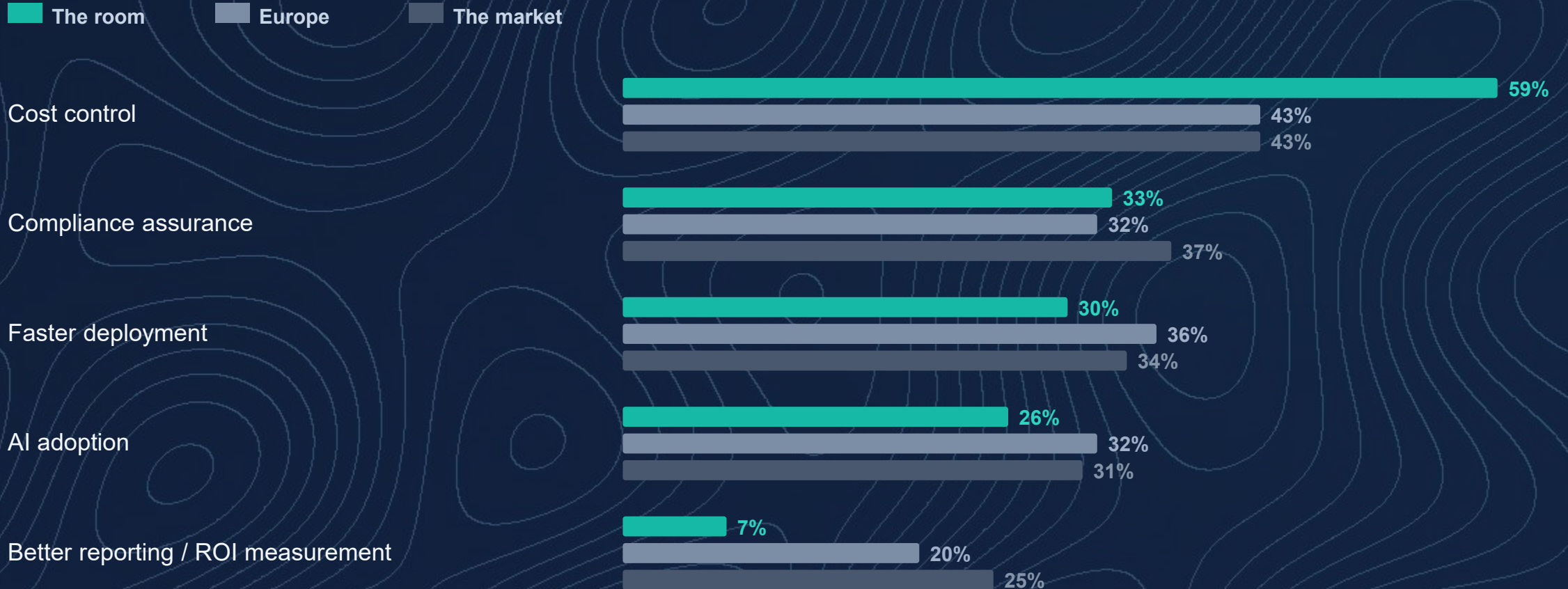
A ROOM IN MOTION · CHANGE EXPECTATIONS FAR ABOVE THE MARKET

Only 7% call their model effective. The window is open.



Current program state. Room base 27 · Europe · Market. Two thirds of the room is mid-review or mid-optimization right now.

Cost dominates. Better reporting and ROI barely registers.

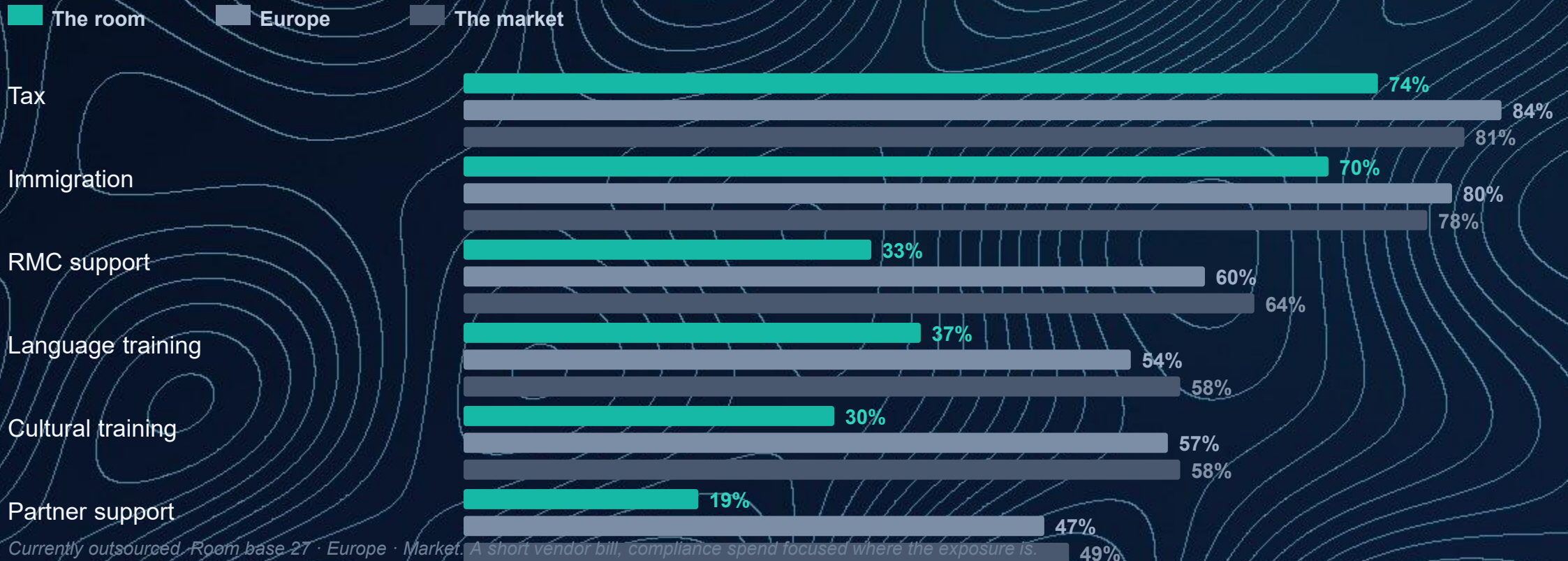


Rising leadership expectations (select up to 3). Room base 27 · Europe · Market. When the cost work lands, the ROI question follows.

THE LEAN VENDOR STACK

Buy the two universals, then stop.

Frankfurt buys tax and immigration at close to market rates, then outsources every peripheral service at roughly half the European rate. Read alongside the cost figures, this looks deliberate.



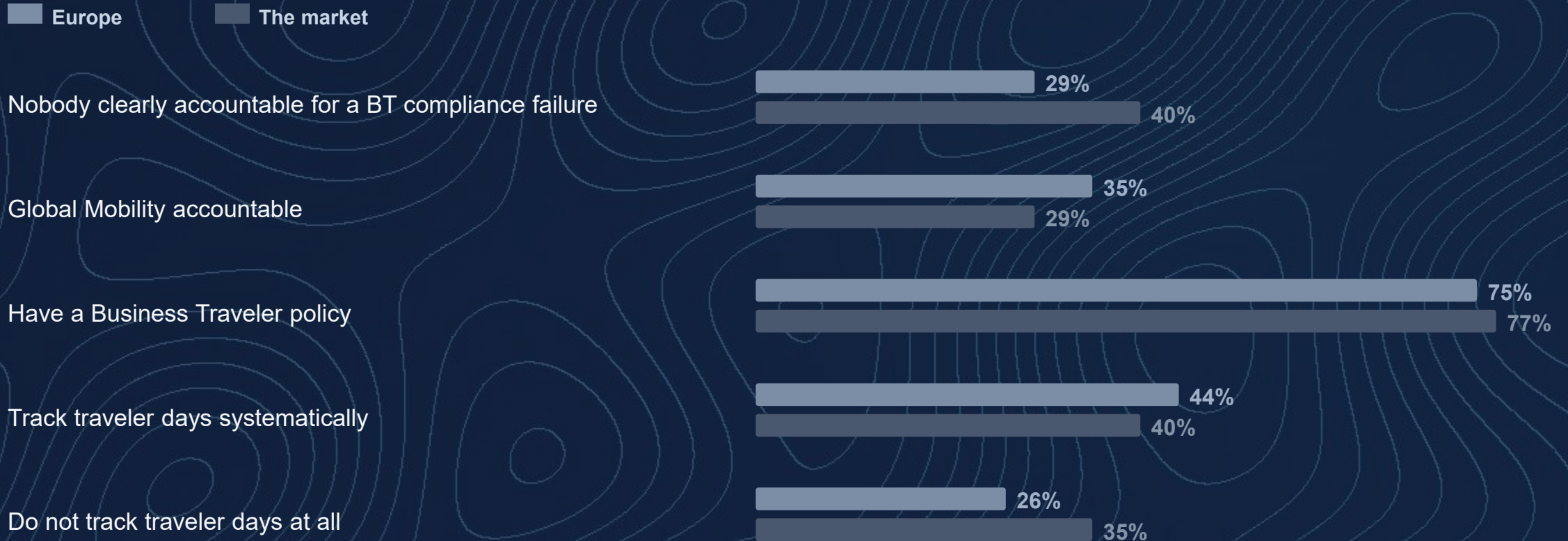


ADDENDUM

What the wider benchmark says about the day's agenda

Four of the day's discussion topics predate the room's registration. The room's own numbers on these do not exist yet, which is exactly the invitation at the end of this report. These figures are Europe and the market only.

The most uncomfortable finding: nobody is clearly accountable.



Bases: accountability Europe 34 / market 48; policy Europe 69 / market 104; tracking Europe 34 / market 48. Policy without tracking is exposure with a cover sheet.

Called a priority far more often than it is funded or measured.



The measurement gap

The most common market answer on how program success is measured is that it is not formally measured at all, ahead of every actual metric. The human layer, ongoing check-ins and wellbeing support, is the least provisioned.

Bases: EE priority and budget Europe 25 / market 71. Success measures and provisions reported by count among organizations answering.

The compliance surface the agenda worries about is already live.

Supporting international remote work

EUROPE

73%

THE MARKET

67%

Two thirds of the market formally supports international remote work; Europe runs ahead at nearly three quarters. In most organizations, the surface is already live.

Bases: Europe 73 · market 110.

SEE WHERE YOU SIT

Every organization in this room built the data. Now every one can see its own position in it.

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